

Brian Elsdén

Operations | Finance | Technology | Leadership



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LINKEDIN.COM/BRIAN-ELSDEN

SKILLS

-professional-

Change management
leadership

Pragmatic problem
resolution

Organizational development

Performance optimization

Capacity & resource
planning

M&A due diligence

Financial acumen

ROI modeling

Strategic partnerships

Analytical thinking

Effective communicator

Data-centric mindset

Market share optimization

Team leadership

Comfortable with ambiguity

Budgeting and Forecasting

Risk assessment

PROFILE

Results focused leader who successfully achieves revenue, cost, productivity, and service objectives. Skilled at building collaboration and cross-functional teams to accomplish infrastructure and organizational development initiatives. Innovative strategist recognized for devising methods to enhance business performance, embracing and navigating through change, and fostering a culture of continuous improvement.

Experienced in M&A diligence decision leadership, acquisition implementation strategy, and enhancing strategic client relationships. Demonstrated ability to identify and develop synergies while mitigating potential risks. Confident under pressure while executing large-scale enterprise initiatives involving the transition of programs to new platforms and the merger of disparate systems from newly acquired business units.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CHANGE MANAGEMENT PRINCIPAL / *Private Consulting Services* 2015 - Present

Client engagement role providing leadership for travel management firms in the customer interface change process related to organizational and IT projects.

- Develop tailored stakeholder engagement campaigns and communication strategies determining enhancements required to streamline operations and effect business process re-engineering.
- Project lead for concurrent SaaS implementations. Manage project life cycle including budget, sourcing, requirements, deliverables, scope, roadmap, risks, responsibilities, compliance controls, and programming.
- Direct change training to foster stakeholder coalition, promote adoption, increase benefit realization, create value proposition, and secure ROI.

DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS / *Travizon, Inc. (Global Travel Solutions)* 2003 - 2015

New strategic and analytical role during sustained growth and change. Partnered with CEO to deliver on service quality, capacity utilization, and margin objectives.

- Provided thought leadership and cohesive direction to management team.
- Developed long term customer success philosophy providing structured implementation, training, feedback, and service quality to deliver value, drive retention, secure recurring revenue, and strengthen partnerships.
- Articulated vision and facilitated organizational transformation to hybrid B2B operating model offering a robust portfolio of contractual agreements that reduced acquisition costs, and created sustainable revenue streams.
- Scaled corporate development from 50 employees to over 300 via blend of organic growth and acquisition. Opened 12 offices and recruited teams.

S K I L L S

-technical-

E-Commerce & SaaS
project management

Advanced Excel (Pivot,
Lookup, Chart, Macro)

Network infrastructure
modernization

Dashboard reporting

PowerPoint presentations

SAP / Concur
implementation

Mid-Office transaction
fulfillment

Contact center engineering
and operation

Relational databases

Salesforce.com

MS Project / Visio

Enterprise financial systems

ConnectWise suite

Travel distribution systems

- Executed pre & post M&A due diligence and provided guidance and support to project teams throughout the deal continuum. Safeguarded against service issues, mitigated attrition, and represented buy-side.
- Engaged with sell-side leaders to reinforce buy in and create structured improvement plans that refined work stream processes, eliminated redundancies, and secured retention by promoting employee feedback.
- Produced consolidated infrastructure project plans, negotiated with strategic telecom providers, and partnered with IT to implement cost-effective solutions required to ramp up capacity and modernize legacy contact center technology that yielded a national virtual service network.
- Designed point-of-sale productivity automation that enhanced contact center agent performance and enriched the customer experience.
- Collaborated with Business Development from preliminary sales through client onboarding functioning as operational management liaison. Collectively outlined SLA measurements and standards. Developed ROI/RFP responses related to service metrics and policy requirements.
- Established lucrative sales incentive program supplementing lost revenue due to elimination of traditional commission-based model. Negotiated contracts and exceeded revenue objectives for 5-year period.
- Developed proprietary Mid-Office robotic systems for enterprise QA standardization supporting client policy adherence, SOX compliance, document delivery, unit cost reduction, and value-added products.
- Implemented 'touch less' automation associated with online transaction fulfillment that improved quality, mitigated associated labor costs, increased margins, and redeployed QA staff to ancillary profit centers.

CONTROLLER / *Fugazy Business Travel, Inc. (Re-branded to Travizon)* 1998 - 2003

Managed Finance team and directed enterprise operations in early stage growth organization. Evaluated target opportunities for strategic deal structuring.

- Responsible for financial controls, analysis, performance improvement, management reporting, contract negotiation, and close procedures.
- Developed and documented financial operating model recommendations.
- Prepared budgets, forecasts, and strategic plans providing clear and measurable targets for growth opportunities. Provided financial analysis related to capital investments, contract negotiations, and pricing.
- Performed due diligence and post-M&A integration of newly acquired companies. Partnered with ownership, counsel, and tax on valuation, P&S negotiation, risks and representations, and corporate filings.
- Centrally consolidated financial operations from newly acquired business units. Managed multiple accounting system upgrade projects.
- Achieved market share objectives via strategic supplier deal structuring.
- Negotiated vendor contracts resulting in 35% overhead reduction.
- Implemented systems to better track bad debt that improved cash position. Reduced aging AR by enrolling customers to card merchant service programs that offered insurance and other value added benefits.

E D U C A T I O N

UNIVERSITY OF MAINE, ORONO
B.S. Business Administration / Finance
